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Trump defends economic policies

President touts levies in visit to Michigan ahead of midterms

By Will Weissert
ASSOCIATED PRESS

MILFORD, Mich. — In a visit to Michigan on Monday, President Donald Trump argued that his economic policies have revived the auto industry and American manufacturing even as many businesses contend that the sweeping tariffs he

has imposed against Canada and the rest of the world have hurt the state. Trump defended his policies while visiting a General Motors facility in the Detroit suburb of Milford that is a testing ground for its vehicles. He pumped a fist after watching Corvette, Cadillac and Hummer vehicles compete in drag races. In a speech, Trump cheered GM's plans to expand production domestically in coming years and declared himself a president who was standing up for autoworkers "at

long last." "I've done more for you than your parents, OK?" he joked. After being led on a tour of vehicles from different eras of GM, some of which he sat in, Trump claimed the tariffs have helped the automaker. "They've come a long way," he said to reporters about the Detroit-based automaker. "It's amazing what tariffs are doing for GM." Trump said he has been good to the company, but he declined to say more. "The rest of the world doesn't

love me, but that's OK," he said, alluding to tariffs. "It's called 'America first.'" Trump called out several Republican candidates and invited them onstage during his remarks Monday. Republican Mike Rogers is unopposed in the Senate primary, but the GOP gubernatorial contest pits Trump-backed Rep. John James against Perry Johnson, a businessman turned politician who has launched unsuccessful campaigns before, including for president in 2024.

Johnson is now trying to style himself in the president's mold — despite missing out on his endorsement. The Democratic Senate primary between Rep. Haley Stevens and progressive Abdul El-Sayed has drawn national attention for the right to face Rogers, who was narrowly defeated by Democrat Sen. Elissa Slotkin in 2024. Early voting is underway. Michigan was one of the 2024

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Illinois teachers sue county treasurer

Union wants Pappas to issue property tax bills and make payments

By A.D. Quig
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The Illinois Federation of Teachers sued Cook County Treasurer Maria Pappas Monday to try to force her to mail property tax bills and compensate school districts for recent revenue delays. The suit was filed in Cook County Circuit Court on behalf of the estimated 50,000 Cook County members of the state Federation of Teachers, including the Chicago Teachers Union and union members across the suburbs. It asks a judge to order Pappas to act "so that families and students in the City and the County will receive the education they have paid for and deserve."

It's part of the CTU's broader push for more funding as Chicago Public Schools feverishly works to pass a budget before the end of the month or risk missing the September payroll and the opportunity to borrow money short term.

While the suit adds pressure, it's unclear whether it can or will move the needle to get bills out the door faster. Pappas has steadfastly insisted the delays are occurring upstream of her office, and there's little she can do to move more quickly.

Pappas' office did not comment on the suit, but did say in a written statement that it anticipates sending CPS a chunk of money this week. The district has said it needs \$85 million to avert implementing furlough days.

The years-long upgrade of the county's property tax system has led to cascading pileups, but few easy fixes. County leaders and its lead contractor, Tyler Technologies, say they've been working overtime to address ongoing defects to pay taxing bodies what they're owed. County leaders are simultaneously playing catch up from last year's problems in order to get bills out the door by Sept. 1, with some optimism they could land sooner. In a typical cycle, bills are sent July 1 with

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CHRIS SWEDA/TRIBUNE

Buddy Guy celebrates 90th in Chicago show

Blues legend enjoys hometown love fest in concert at Chicago Theatre. **Arts & Living, Page B7**



EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Severe storms pound, drench area

Robert Skolnik speaks to a neighbor as he looks at storm damage in front of his house on Elmwood Avenue near Dempster Street in Evanston on Monday. **Chicagoland, Page 3**



Intern Santiago Gutiérrez, right, and employee Gilberto Macario make birria beef at Tacotlán restaurant in Belmont Gardens in Chicago on Wednesday. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

From salons to taquerías, CPS students get a chance to work

Summer internship program provides real-world experience

By Kate Armanini
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

At a hair salon in the Bronzeville neighborhood on a recent morning, half a dozen teens braided, pressed and curled colorful wigs on a line of mannequins. Each wore a T-shirt rendered with a pink logo: Branding You Salon. Morgan Witherspoon lathered shampoo into a client's

tight coils. As an intern, the 17-year-old shadows a professional hairdresser and styles customers' hair. She squeezed a dollop of conditioner into her palm. "I just want you to use a dime-sized amount, just a dime," said instructor Chris Curse, peering over her shoulder. "Girl, that's a whole quarter, but we're gonna go ahead and go with it." Witherspoon is one of 1,400 students participating in a Chicago Public Schools summer internship this year, a six-week program aimed at connecting teens with real-world work

experience. CPS pays students a stipend of up to \$2,000 after placement at one of 300 partner sites, including restaurants, nonprofits and small businesses. CPS leaders say the initiative is designed to expose students to career pathways they might not otherwise access. Participation has grown in recent years, up from 1,000 students in 2022. The district, which is facing a deficit of more than \$730 million this budget season, funds the program through a mix of grants, philanthropy and partnerships.

See **STUDENTS** on Page A2

Naperville native headlining at Lolla

'Rising star' DJ John Summit to get spotlight at music fest

By Carolyn Stein
NAPERVILLE SUN

Tamara Schuster knew she would never force her kids to play piano. Growing up, the 64-year-old Naperville resident was pushed by her own parents at a young age to pursue the instrument. Despite being a self-described music lover, she vowed her children would not feel the same pressure. Yet both her daughter and son ended up gravitating toward the piano. Her son, John, repeatedly asked her to buy one when he was in elementary school. "I remember asking him more than once, 'Are you sure?'" Schuster said. "I went to Costco and got one of those (electric) pianos. ... I still have it by the way. (The kids) loved it." Nearly 18 years later, the world knows John Schuster these days as John Summit, "one of EDM's biggest rising stars," according to Variety magazine in 2024, and a headliner this week at the Lollapalooza music fest in Chicago's Grant Park. Since his rise to fame in 2020,

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